



A FEMALE ROBINSON CRUSOE.—San Francisco papers contain a very interesting account of an Indian woman, who was abandoned on San Nicolas Island, on the coast of Southern California, and spent eighteen years alone there before she was rescued. The woman went to the island with a party of natives and left them to go into the interior and gather wood. Returning, she found the party in canoes and about to sail. Not finding her three children in the boats she swam ashore. She did not find her children, but supposed they were [devoured by the wild dogs on the island. She became very sick and lay a long time without either water or food, but finally recovered and forgot her grief in wandering about the island. She lived on a plant resembling the cabbage, roots, seal or sea-lion blubber. As she had abalone shell fish hooks and lines made of the sinews of the seal, it is probable she supplied herself with fish from the ocean.—Eighteen years after this, a party visited the island on an otter and seal hunt. The Indian woman was found in one of the pens

the island on an otter and seal hunt. The Indian woman was found in one of the pens she had built as a wind-break. She was clothed in a garment made of the skins of the shag, without sleeves, low neck, and, as observed when standing up, extending almost to the ankle. She was sitting, cross-legged, skinning seal blubber with a rude knife, made of a piece of hoop-iron driven into a piece of wood.

There was no covering on her head excepting a thick mass of matted hair of a yellowish brown color, due to the exposure to the sun and air. The hair was short, looking as if the free ends had rotted off. There were several wild dogs about the enclosure, which growled savagely at the visitors, but were driven off by their mistress. The woman made no attempt to get away. The woman appeared to be very happy in her island home, but it took very little to induce her to leave. She landed at Santa Barbara and was a great curiosity. Change of food and habits so affected her constitution that she lived but four or five weeks after her arrival at her new home.